

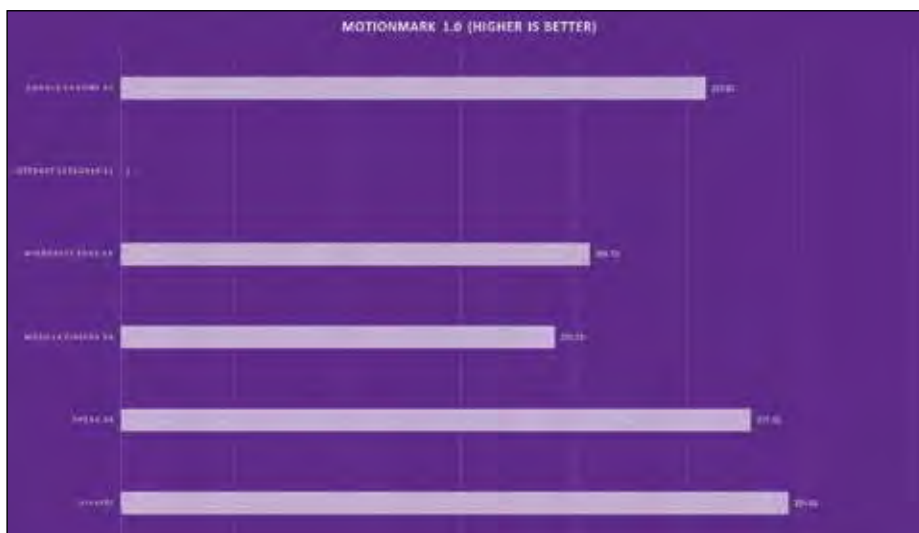
### Blue Origin's BE-4 engine tested

Capable of 550,000 pounds-force of thrust, the BE-4 can place 45 tonnes into low Earth orbit and 13 tonnes into GTO. <http://digit.in/B0test>



### Plants that fight back

Damaging "overcompensators" sets off a chain reaction that causes them to grow back bigger and produce defenses faster. <http://digit.in/VegFight>



and memory management is decent on Firefox, but its CPU usage is the worst. But Mozilla is working to completely get rid of these problems by shifting to a new rendering engine. Essentially, Firefox will soon be receiving an overhaul on the backend with some distinct changes in the user interface.

Firefox is still large with the features it offers and it also has an abundant library of add-ons. If Chrome and Firefox are placed side-by-side, the lag on Firefox is distinctly visible in its user interface. Customisability is also good enough here, but Vivaldi went next level with giving the users more options. More than the existing Firefox (version 56), we are excited about Firefox Quantum which is said to completely change the game for the browser veteran.

## MOZILLA FIREFOX QUANTUM

It's been a long time since we made a permanent switch from Firefox to Chrome. It almost seems like Google was able to crack the formula for web browsers back then, and maintained it for all these years. With its new project called Quantum (version 57 onwards), Firefox aims to get back the top spot. With Quantum, Mozilla aims to make their upcoming web browser twice as fast as Chrome, while

using 30 per cent less memory!

In order to achieve this lofty goal, Mozilla created the Servo project – a new web browser engine that's written in Rust and is supposed to be high-performance. They have been pushing minor chunks of features from the new engine to the existing Gecko engine. They also developed a new CSS engine called Stylo that can run parallelly on multiple CPU cores, something they claim no one else does. To top it all, they developed the Photon project to improve their user-interface and we'll admit, that the current beta implementation is smoother than Chrome. However, the CPU and RAM usage aren't where they want to be just yet, but we'll hold off judgement until the final release. It's coming on November

14, 2017, so it should be out soon after you read this.

## OPERA

Looking at only the front-end, most web browsers differ in the design, user interface and the set of native features thrown in. At this point, the one which offers a little extra while delivering great performance easily becomes a favourite. Why that favourite isn't Opera is a mystery to us – it's a grossly underrated browser on the desktop. Having shifted to Blink, Opera's performance is almost identical to Chrome.

It only lags behind in page load speeds in our real-world testing. HTML5 support was also impressive.

There are many useful features on Opera that not everyone has incorporated natively. Opera has its Turbo Mode that takes care of slow page loads by rerouting the traffic through their servers. You'll have to manually enable it from advanced settings. It has a screenshotting tool, reading mode, VPN, ad blocker, battery saver, etc. One unique feature we found ourselves using a lot was the in-built currency convertor that worked with just highlighting the amount. You can obviously choose your preferred currency. If it wasn't for its relatively lower real-world performance, Opera would have won the comparison.

